Presentation

Introduction

Characteristics of a Good Presentation

Plan

Prepare

Practice

Group Presentation

Introduction

What?

- The process of presenting a topic to an audience.
- A means of oral communication, a method of sharing your views, ideas and information orally.

How?

- Impromptu – Least to no preparation
- Extemporaneous – Cue cards and points
- Scripted – Direct reading
- Memorized – Verbatim, without the supporting material

Characteristics of a Good Presentation

- Begins in an effective manner
- Has ideas logically developed
- Presents ideas in a persuasive way
- Makes audience interested in the presentation
- Makes use of appropriate visuals
- Reflects confidence of the speaker
- Has a memorable conclusion

1. Planning the presentation

Know the Purpose of your presentation

- To inform- to share information (for training/ teaching)
- To persuade- to change behaviour, attitude, belief (for sales/ marketing)
- To demonstrate- to help listeners know how to do something (for product or idea demonstrate)

Analyse the Occasion

- Meetings, Seminars, and Conferences
- Research paper presentations
- Company profile presentations
- Product marketing, academic presentations
- Workshops and recruitment presentations

Audience

Know the audience

Social economic group

Education/ profession

Reason for attending

2. Preparing the Presentation

PREPARING THE INTRODUCTION:

- Get Audience Attention
  - Startling statements/Statistics/Anecdote/Question/Quotation/Humour
- Introduce the Topic
- Explain the purpose of the presentation
- State your Central idea
- Provide a Preview of Main Ideas

Preparing the Body of presentation

BODY:

- Have one Central Idea:
- Developing 4-6 Main Ideas that logically divide the central idea
- Gather Supporting Material- -from subject knowledge; internet, library, personal interviews, discussions with experts, colleagues, special interest groups
- Planning Visual Aids – add only relevant visual aids; be familiar with them

Preparing presentation graphics/Using Visual Aids

IMPORTANCE OF VISUAL AIDS

For presenter-(a) serve as speech notes

- (b) Give clarity and precision to the presenter
- (c) Give confidence to presenter - can refresh memory

For audience - (a) Help focus on the theme of presentation

- (b) Central ideas gets highlighted, systematic flow of thought
- (c) Increases audience interest – even demotivated audience will pay attention
- (d) Signals transition from one part of the presentation to the next.

Types of Visual Aids

- Three dimensional- Objects, models, people
- Two dimensional- Drawings, photographs, slides, maps, graphs-bar pie line picture, chalk board, charts, computer generated presentation- PPT/Google slides

- Remember they are aids and should not dominate your presentation
- Do not overuse
- Watch https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KbSPPFYxx3o Life after Death by Power point

Preparing the Conclusion

SUMMARIZE IN THE CONCLUSION PART:

- Let your summary be quick and short
- Explore creative ways to recall your key points
- Focus on a goal-i.e. what you want your audience to do, think, change, remember and so on
- Motivate the audience to respond – to give feedback ,encourage to ask question

3. Practice/Rehearsing and Handling nerves before the presentation

It is natural to feel nervous when presenting in front of others, regardless of the size of the audience.

Here are some tips:

- Remind yourself that the audience is there to listen to you and wants you to do well; there is no need to be afraid of them.
- Remember that the audience members will have to present their projects later and are almost certainly feeling just as nervous.
- Practicing with your group and practicing your section at home will make you more comfortable and familiar with the material and increase your confidence.

Effective Delivery (Verbal + Non-verbal)

Verbal elements

- Enthusiasm and sincerity
- Adjust volume
- Avoid fast delivery, monotones or vocalized pauses
- optimal pitch
- Use silence and pauses effectively
- Articulation
- Smooth flow- transition words (meanwhile, however) Number item (First, second) Trigger (repetition of same word)

Non-verbal elements

- Personal appearance
- Facial expressions
- Eye contact
- Well-timed gestures
- Posture: tall and straight with shoulders upright; walk/move swiftly
- Maintain apt. distance
- Avoid monotonous gestures

Delivering the Presentation

Calming Your Nerves



Apprehension about public speaking is common. Keep in mind three facts about nervousness:

- You are much more **AWARE** of your nervousness than the audience is.
- Nervousness gives you **ENERGY** and **ENTHUSIASM**.
- After a few minutes, your **NERVOUSNESS WILL PASS**.

Experienced speakers offer three tips for coping with nervousness:

- Realize that you are **PREPARED**.
- Realize that **THE AUDIENCE IS THERE TO HEAR YOU**, not to judge you.
- Realize that your audience is made up of **INDIVIDUAL PEOPLE** who happen to be sitting in the same room.

Releasing Nervous Energy



Experienced speakers suggest the following four strategies for dealing with nervousness before a presentation:

- **WALK AROUND BRISKLY** for a minute or two.
- **TALK WITH SOMEONE** for a few minutes.
- **GO OFF BY YOURSELF** for a few minutes and compose your thoughts.
- **TAKE SEVERAL DEEP BREATHS**, exhaling slowly.

Following these six recommendations can help you handle nervousness during a presentation:

- **WALK UP SLOWLY** and **ARRANGE YOUR NOTES** at the podium.
- **TAKE A SIP OF WATER** if it is available.
- **LOOK OUT AT THE AUDIENCE** for a few seconds before you begin.
- **BEGIN WITH "GOOD MORNING"** (or "Good afternoon" or "Good evening"), and refer to any officers and dignitaries present. If you have not been introduced, introduce yourself. In less-formal contexts, just begin.
- Use your voice and your body to **PROJECT AN ATTITUDE OF RESTRAINED SELF-CONFIDENCE**.
- **SHOW INTEREST** in your topic and knowledge about your subject.

From left to right: (1) Majivecka/Shutterstock; (2) Fiscus777/Shutterstock

Using Your Voice Effectively



Inexperienced speakers often have problems with five aspects of vocalizing:

- **VOLUME.** Acoustics vary greatly from room to room, so you won't know how well your voice will carry in a particular setting. Ask if the people in the back of the room can hear you. Look at your audience's body language to see if you need to adjust the volume if you're using a microphone.
- **SPEED.** Nervousness makes people speak quickly. Even if you think you are speaking at the right rate, you might be going too fast. For particularly difficult points, slow down for emphasis. After finishing one major point, pause.
- **PITCH.** Try to let the pitch of your voice go up or down, as it would in a normal conversation, rather than flattening it.
- **ARTICULATION.** Nervousness can accentuate sloppy pronunciation. When a speaker uses a phrase over and over, it tends to get clipped.
- **NONFLUENCIES.** Avoid such meaningless fillers as *you know*, *like*, *okay*, *right*, *uh*, and *um*.

Using Your Body Effectively



As you give a presentation, keep in mind these four guidelines about physical movement:

- **MAINTAIN EYE CONTACT** so you can see how the audience is receiving the presentation. With small groups, look at each listener randomly; with larger groups, look at each segment frequently.
- **USE NATURAL GESTURES.** Supplement your natural gestures by using your arms and hands to signal pauses and to emphasize points. When referring to graphics, walk toward the screen and point. Avoid physical gestures such as pacing that serve no useful purpose.
- Don't block the audience's view of the screen. **STAND OFF TO THE SIDE OF THE SCREEN** and refer to it with a pointer.
- **CONTROL** the audience's **ATTENTION.** When you want the audience to look at you and listen to you, remove the graphics from the screen or let the screen go blank.

From left to right: (1) Nowik Sylwia/Shutterstock; (2) Vectomart/Shutterstock

Group Presentation

The group must be well organized because there are multiple individuals, and therefore multiple personalities involved.

1. Understanding the audience
2. The presentation's purpose
3. Share responsibility
4. Divide the presentation
5. Build the presentation together
6. Presentation moderation
7. Know what each speaker will say
8. Write and practice transitions
9. Practice the presentation